09-24 第1篇

阅读理解（记叙文） The Small Tree My Father and I Planted

① When I was nine years old, my father and I planted a **small camphor tree** in the corner of our back yard, next to the low stone wall. It was a soft Saturday morning in late March; the air smelled of warm earth and new rain. The tree was thin — **no thicker than my wrist** — and its leaves were the tender, almost golden green that only young camphor trees have in spring. My father dug a round hole, put in the tree, filled the hole with soft soil, and asked me to step gently on the earth around it. "Now it is yours," he said simply. "Talk to it sometimes. Trees can listen, if you wait."

② I laughed at him. I was nine, and trees, I knew, could not listen. But that afternoon I did tell the tree my name, in a small whispered voice, and I told it the name of my best friend Xiao Le, and I told it that I hated long division and liked the warm smell of our kitchen at dinner time. Then I ran inside and forgot about the tree for most of a week.

③ For the next four years, my father and I watered the tree together every Saturday morning. Once, in the **summer of my Grade 6**, a strong typhoon bent the young tree almost to the ground. I thought it was finished. But my father drove three thin bamboo sticks into the earth around it, tied the trunk upright with soft cloth, and said, "It's not broken, only frightened." He was right. Two weeks later, it stood straight again, a little more careful but alive. My father wrote the date on the bamboo stick: *July 2022*.

④ When I started Grade 8, my father's work took him to another city. For the first time in my life, he was away for months. Our Saturday mornings changed — now my mother and I watered the tree together. I was taller; the tree was taller, thicker, and its top leaves reached a bit above the stone wall. On cold autumn evenings, after homework, I would sometimes sit on the narrow wooden bench beside the tree, doing my English reading aloud. The tree did not listen, of course. But the stone wall, the smell of wet earth, the darker green of the older leaves — all of them together made a **quiet listening shape** around me. I began to understand what my father had meant, years ago, by "trees can listen, if you wait."

⑤ Last autumn, on a Sunday morning close to my fourteenth birthday, my father came home for one weekend. He looked tired. We ate noodles together. After lunch, we walked slowly to the back yard to see the tree. It now reached higher than my shoulder plus my father's head combined. My father looked at it for a long time without saying anything. Then he said, "Xinyi, I would like to tell you something I have never told you." I waited. "Your grandfather planted the **loquat tree** in the front yard, in 1965, three days after I was born. He died when I was thirteen. But every time I watered the loquat tree as a boy,

I felt that he was still there, in the corner of my eye." He put his hand gently on the camphor. "One day, I will be away too. But you will have this tree. And I hope that, when you water it, you will feel — as I did — that a small piece of love is still with you."

⑥ I did not reply for a while. A small wind came and moved the camphor's leaves with a soft, dry sound. My father took an old pocket knife from his coat, and very carefully carved two tiny letters low on the trunk, just above the soil: **"F & X"** — my father's family name and my own. "There," he said, almost to himself. "Now the tree remembers, even if one day we forget." Then we walked inside, and my mother brought hot tea.

⑦ My father is still away for most of the year. The camphor tree is still in the corner of the back yard. I no longer whisper secrets to it in a silly voice as I did when I was nine. But every Saturday morning, rain or sun, I take the blue watering can from the shed, fill it at the tap, and give the tree its water. On very cold nights in winter, when my father's voice is only a phone call away, I walk out just for a minute, touch the small carved letters low on the trunk, and feel the quiet, **shoulder-to-shoulder kind of company** a tree can give. Some lessons, I begin to see, are **not taught in classrooms**. Some lessons are watered slowly, Saturday by Saturday, until one day you notice that you have grown — and so has something else, quietly standing in the corner of your life.

注释： camphor tree 香樟树；long division 长除法；typhoon 台风；loquat 枇杷；pocket knife 小刀；watering can 浇水壶

根据文章内容，选择最佳答案。

1. How old was the writer when she planted the small camphor tree with her father?

A. About five years old.
B. Nine years old, on a soft Saturday morning in late March.
C. Twelve years old.
D. Already in Grade 9.

2. What happened to the young tree in the summer of Grade 6?

A. It was cut down by a neighbour.
B. It grew so tall that it broke the wall.
C. A strong typhoon bent it almost to the ground, and the father saved it with three thin bamboo sticks and soft cloth.
D. It was burned in a small fire.

3. Why does the writer begin to understand what the father meant by "trees can listen, if you wait" (Paragraph 4)?

A. Because she suddenly hears the tree speaking a human language.
B. Because, while sitting on the bench and reading aloud, the stone wall, the smell of wet

earth and the darker leaves together feel like a quiet listening shape around her.
C. Because the tree grows wings and starts flying.
D. Because she stops doing her homework completely.

4. What story did the father tell the writer when she was close to fourteen (Paragraph 5)?

A. He told her about a trip he had taken to a foreign country.
B. He told her that her grandfather had planted the loquat tree in 1965 three days after his own birth; he died when the father was thirteen, but watering the loquat tree had made the father feel that his own father was still with him.
C. He told her she must cut down the camphor tree.
D. He told her he had bought a new car.

5. What does the writer realise in the last paragraph?

A. That the tree will one day break again.
B. That some important lessons are not taught in classrooms; they are watered slowly, Saturday by Saturday, and the tree has given her a quiet, shoulder-to-shoulder kind of company.
C. That she should stop watering the tree.
D. That she dislikes her family and wants to move away.

答案与解析

1.
【答案】B
【题型】细节理解题
【定位】第①段 "When I was nine years old ... soft Saturday morning in late March"
【解析】种树时作者 9 岁。A、C、D 均错。故选 B。

2.
【答案】C
【题型】细节理解题
【定位】第③段 "a strong typhoon bent the young tree ... drove three thin bamboo sticks into the earth"
【解析】台风吹弯树干，父亲用竹竿扶正。A、B、D 均错。故选 C。

3.
【答案】B
【题型】细节理解题
【定位】第④段 "the stone wall, the smell of wet earth ... quiet listening shape around me"
【解析】周围环境给她"被聆听"的感觉。A、C、D 均错。故选 B。

4.
【答案】B
【题型】细节理解题
【定位】第⑤段 "Your grandfather planted the loquat tree in the front yard, in 1965 ... felt that he was still there"
【解析】父亲讲述爷爷种枇杷树的往事及情感寄托。A、C、D 均错。故选 B。

5.
【答案】B
【题型】主旨/观点题
【定位】第⑦段 "not taught in classrooms ... watered slowly, Saturday by Saturday ... shoulder-to-shoulder kind of company"
【解析】末段揭示成长之课来自日积月累和陪伴。A、C、D 均偏离。故选 B。